

The Unknown Tower and Halls

By Steven K Allen

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6	Mongrelman 4 HD (10): Int. Low to Average (5-10); AL LN; AC 5; MV 9; HD 4; hp 15, 20, 23, 2x14, 2x16, 19, 26, 12; THAC0 17; #AT 1; Dmg 1-10 or by weapon type; SD Camouflage, Mimicry; SZ M; ML Steady (12); XP 175.
7	Carrion Crawler : Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 12; HD 3+1; hp 15; THAC0 17; #AT 1 or 8; Dmg Either bite for 1-2 or 8 tentacle attacks for paralysis.; SA Paralysis; SZ L; ML Fearless (20); XP 420.
8	Giant, Fomorian (4): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL NE; AC 3; MV 9; HD 13+3; hp 63, 62, 64, 66; THAC0 9; #AT 1; Dmg 2d4 + 8 or by weapon (2x normal damage + 8); SA Surprise; SD Only surprised on a 1; SZ H; ML Elite (14); XP 6,000.
9	Xorn : Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL N; AC -2; MV 9, Br 9; HD 7+7; hp 44; THAC0 13; #AT 4; Dmg 1-3/1-3/1-3/6-24; SA Surprise, pass through stone; SD immune to fire & cold, half dmg from edged weapons & electrical attacks; SZ M; ML Champion (16); XP 4,000.
10	Orc, Shaman 6HD: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 6; hp 36; THAC0 11; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon); SA spells as 6th level priest; SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 675; Memorized: <i>Light, Cure Light Wounds</i> (x2), <i>Cause Light Wounds</i>, <i>Shillelagh</i>, <i>Hold Person</i>, <i>Cloak of Fear</i>¹⁶. Orc, Subchief: Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 4; MV 9; HD 1d1+10; hp 11; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon, +1 damage); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35. Orc, Leader (5): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 4; MV 9; HD 2; hp 16, 10, 12, 8, 4; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon, +1 damage); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 35. Orc assistant (15): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 1d1+7; hp 15x8; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (weapon); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 15. Orc with sword and flail (10): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL LE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 1; hp 4, 8, 2x1, 3x5, 2, 6, 3; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8 (sword) or 2-7 (flail); SZ M; ML Steady (11-12); XP 15.

Speaking the correct answer to the riddle found near the arch activates the two teleporting arches found within the Under Halls. The answer must be spoken in the same language as the riddle was written in. Other than trial and error, there is no way to discern if an answer was correct. Tossing items such as copper coins or small stones into the arch and seeing if they disappear is probably the safest way to test the validity of an answer. After speaking the correct answer, the arches will transport up to 12 individual items one way, for game purposes consider an adventurer and all carried gear as one item. Each arch is useable once per day and remains activated for a turn before shutting off.

A mage that has carefully studied portals, gates, and similar devices or has consulted with sages about these devices has a chance determined by the DM to possess some knowledge of the workings of portals. The DM according to his campaign determines the results of casting such magics as *Legend Lore* upon the gates.

Room #1, A Hot Arrival.

You arrive in a dark, dry hellishly hot hallway that is 15' wide and 50' long. The walls are made of smoothed stone mined from the rock and rise nine feet to support a smooth roof. Behind you is a blank stonewall; ahead of you (facing south) the hallway terminates in a pair of stone doors shut tightly.

The temperature within this hallway is about 155° Fahrenheit that renders infravision useless. Proceeding south, the temperature lowers slightly.

The native stone twin doors are devoid of any knobs, handles or latches. Both doors are *Wizard Locked* by a 16th level mage. Dispelling the *Wizard Lock* spell allows the doors to open into the next room. No wards are upon the doors preventing other magics. Using such spells as *Dimension Door* and *Teleport* allows the characters to pass through.

Room #2, A Strange Doorman.

On the other side of the double doors, the hallway continues for another 20' ending in another pair of double stone doors identical to the previous doors. However, standing in front of these new doors is an eight-foot tall earth-brown humanoid. Midway through the hall a faint red light emanates from a large glowing symbol upon the floor, dimly lighting the hallway. The temperature is noticeably cooler here than in the previous hallway (about 109° Fahrenheit). The roof starts at nine feet high at the door but rises sharply to about 12' high at the new pair of doors. As you enter the hallway, the large humanoid begins a slow lumbering walk towards you.

Placed here to defend these doors from intruders the tall humanoid is a clay golem commanded to let drow pass only. If the adventuring party includes drow, the golem ignores these adventurers and attacks the other adventurers only. Its command word is "abbil¹⁷" (Drow for comrade or trusted friend) which returns it to a dormant state and allows access to the doors.

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Golem, Lesser, Clay: Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 7; MV 7; HD 11; hp 49; THAC0 9; #AT 1; Dmg 3-30 (3d10); SA Can haste self for 3 rounds after one round of combat, damage from a clay golem can only be healed by a priest of 17th-level or greater; SD Hit only by magical blunt weapons, immune to fear, sleep, hold and charm spells; SZ L; ML Fearless (19-20); XP 8,000.

Casting a *Detect Magic* spell upon the symbol reveals that it is very magical and a *legend lore* spell reveals that it serves as a magical beacon for teleportation.

Protected by two 16th-level spells (*Wizard Lock*, and *Wyvern Watch*) the doors are otherwise identical to the first pair of doors.

Room #3, A Deadly Trap.

Upon opening the second set of double doors, you see a dark hallway 25' long. For the first 10' of the hall, its width is 15', but then it narrows to five feet wide. At the same spot that the hall narrows, the roof height also drops from 12' high to six feet. This room is noticeably cooler than the previous rooms (subterranean ambient temperature) and ends in a single blank stone door, similar to the previous double doors.

This door also bears two 16th-level spells: *Wizard Lock* and *Wyvern Watch*. The area at the point where the hall narrows and the roof height drops, is covered by a 16th-level *Alarm* spell. Searching for secret doors or traps reveals a small pressure plate under the door. Stepping upon the plate or moving it sets off a two-part mechanical and magical trap. The first part of the trap will slam shut and lock the doors at either end of the hall (or just lock them if they are already shut). Once the doors are shut and locked, they can not be unlocked from inside the room, although the room is not warded against magic and spells like *Dimension Door*, and *Teleport* allows escape from the hall. Upon completion of the first part of the trap, the second part of the trap lifts the cover to a modified *Eversmoking Bottle*¹⁸ vented into the hallway that emits sleep smoke instead of the usual variety of smoke. Smoke fills the room within one round and all characters within the room must save versus poison each round with a –2 penalty. Those characters failing their saving throw fall asleep for 1d4 days.

The drow, alerted by the *Alarm* spell, lie in wait for the sleep smoke to take effect (about a round) at which time Madame Nova will cast a *Wizard Eye* spell sending it into the room to ascertain what the trap has caught. Any character still awake causes Madame Nova to wait for the effect of the smoke before opening the trap. When all characters are asleep, she speaks the command word (“nepo” known only to Madame Nova) that shuts the stopper of the *Eversmoking Bottle*. After closing the bottle, she orders the trap opened and custody taken of the prisoners. Characters caught by Madame Nova wake up in the stockade stripped of all items but their clothing, including magical or very valuable clothing. The DM should skip ahead in this adventure to room #6. Evading this trap warrants an experience point bonus determined by the DM.

Room #4, A Maiden in Waiting.

This hallway is five feet wide and 30' long and has a six-foot high ceiling. This hall ends in a single stone door with an inset intricate iron lock. As you approach the southern end of the hall, the temperature begins to climb rapidly and quickly gets uncomfortable.

Searching for secret doors reveals a single secret stone door on the eastern wall about five feet from the entry. This door is locked both magically and mechanically. Searching for traps upon the secret door reveals the kissing maiden hidden in the roof triggered by attempting to pick the lock. Rendering the trap inoperable requires hammering some spikes into the surrounding stone preventing the kissing maiden from falling or finding and pulling the secret deactivation lever beside the door. Triggering the trap releases the kissing maiden that strikes any man-sized or larger creature in front of the door doing 4d8 points of damage and those struck must save versus poison because the spikes are coated with type E poison. Creatures smaller than man-sized and any creature under 5' 10" such as gnomes and halflings escape harm because they are below the reach of the trap. Finally after the disarming the trap, and picking the lock (with a –30% penalty to success due to its intricacies) the door still bears a 16th-level *Wizard Lock* spell.

The southern door is locked by the intricate iron lock and is also trapped with an identical kissing maiden as the secret door. Attempting to pick the lock or opening the door such as with a knock spell triggers the kissing maiden. This kissing maiden can be deactivated the same way as the previous one. After disarming the trap, picking the intricate iron lock suffers a –10% chance of success.

Room #5, Grisly Welcome.

Upon opening the secret door, you see a 15' wide, 35' long room lit with several floating glass globes of light. The roof is six-foot high and pierced with murder holes. A single iron-reinforced oak door on the northern wall leads from this room. The room reeks of decaying flesh and standing near the center of this room are 17 undead. Two of these undead are male humans dressed in fine robes with good chain mail underneath. Both wears sheathed short swords

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hanging from a leather balderics. Studying them, you realize that they must have been identical twins in life. The pair bow to you and say in unison "Welcome to Madame's foyer, may we see your invitations please?"

These undead are Madame Nova's door guard and are animated by her consort, who is presently absent from the complex and not part of this adventure, but the DM could use him later for future adventures that tie in to this one. Talking to the two ju-ju zombie brothers politely causes one of them to politely leave, unlock the door and enter the following room. The rest of the zombies wait with the remaining brother until the zombie returns asking that they please remain here because Madame Nova would like to speak to them. Madame Nova will enter the room escorted by seven drow males and politely converses with the characters, offering what help she can, perhaps in exchange for something.

If attacked, or treated rudely, the twin brothers attack while screaming for help. Underneath this room accessed with a large secret trap door, is a large compartment within the floor that contains several undead. Within this compartment are two zombie lords, and two more ju-ju zombies, all twin brothers (the consort likes to collect twin brothers). The zombie lords carefully watch the characters entry and dealings with the first two ju-ju zombies and will command the remainder of the undead from this secret compartment to attack the characters along with the zombies in the room above. The two zombie lords will not enter combat unless forced too, but will get close enough so that their stench reaches the characters.

Zombie, Lord (2): Int. 8-10 Average (human) intelligence; AL NE; AC 6; MV 6; HD 6; hp 34, 31; THAC0 15; #AT 2; Dmg 2-8/2-8; SA odor (save vs poison); SD Spell immunity; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 650.

When forced into combat, it relies on the great strength of its two crushing fists. The odor of death surrounding the zombie lord is so potent it causes horrible effects in those who breathe it. On the first round a character comes within 30 yards, he must save vs. poison or be affected in some way. The following results are possible:

1d6 Roll	Effect
1	Weakness (as the spell).
2	Cause disease (as the spell).
3	-1 point of Constitution.
4	Contagion (as the spell).
5	Character unable to act for 1d4 rounds due to nausea and vomiting.
6	Character dies instantly and becomes a zombie under control of the zombie lord.

All zombies within sight of the zombie lord are subject to its mental instructions. Further, the creature can use the senses of any zombie within a mile of it to learn all that is happening within a very large area. Once per day, the zombie lord can animate dead to transform dead creatures into zombies. This works as described in the Player's Handbook except that it can be used on the living. Any living creature with fewer Hit Dice than the zombie lord can be attacked in this manner. A target that fails a saving throw vs. death is slain. In 1d4 rounds, the slain creature rises as a zombie under the zombie lord's command.

Zombie, Ju-ju (4): Int. 5-7 Low intelligence; AL NE; AC 6; MV 9; HD 3+12; hp 22, 26, 24, 23; THAC0 15; #AT 1; Dmg 3-12 or by weapon; SD immune to all mind effecting spells and illusions, immune to electricity, magic missiles, fire causes ½ damage, +1 or better weapon to hit, B & P weapons do 1/2 dmg, turned as spectres; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 975; each wears a decent set of chain mail, and wields a short sword.

Zombie, Common (35): Int. 0 Nonintelligent or not ratable; AL N; AC 8; MV 6; HD 2; hp 7x9, 15, 4, 7, 5x10, 8x12, 8x11, 2, 8; THAC0 19; #AT 1; Dmg 1-8; SD Spell immunity; SZ M; ML Fearless (20); XP 65.

The murder holes in the ceiling are for intimidation and are not real. Upon the western wall is the large winch for raising the kissing maiden.

Room #6, Madam Nova's Parlor.

The room where the adventurers awake in area #A behind a steel portcullis, if they were captured by the smoke bottle trap. In the center of this portcullis is a small door about three feet tall and four feet wide. Inset within the door is a very intricate padlock. The adventurers find themselves stripped of all gear and items except for clothing. Anything of a magical nature will be removed and studied by the renegade Drow, who may or may not return it to the owner. Standing on the other side of the portcullis facing the prisoners are a pair of Drow fighters with short recurve bows, each with an arrow knocked on the bowstring.

The DM must adjust the following room description to fit his campaign and the events that has happened so far in the adventure. This adventure is not written with the intent of the characters battling the Drow, so descriptions of the

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complex are left to the DM to detail as befits his campaign. The DM should make it clear to the players that their characters are outmatched and that discretion is better than a suicide attack against these Drow.

This is a large, opulently furnished room with rich tapestries hanging on the walls. The room is 40' long and 25' wide with an arched roof that peaks at 12' high. Several chandeliers containing glowing glass globes hang from the roof on delicate fine metal chains dimly light the room. Several padded couches covered in dark leathers are scattered throughout the room, upon which several Drow of either sex and varied ages recline watching you intently. Upon three throne-like couches recline three female Drow each dressed in exquisite clothing and displaying a great amount of jewelry and weapons. The central female Drow is more elderly than the other two who sit in a posture suggesting subservience to the older female. Although older, her beauty has not diminished, but the steel of her will is evident in the respectful stance of everyone around her. The older female reaches into her loose robes and pulls a silver canister from which a silver goblet is extracted. Holding the goblet out, a young male rushes to fill it with a sparkling green wine. Although being unobtrusive, scattered throughout the room are 15 Drow warriors dressed in fine dark chain mail, over which a soft cloak is worn and high soft boots on the feet. Some of these warriors are quietly talking among themselves.

When the characters awake, one of the guards outside the portcullis calls quietly to Madame Nova will come to the bars by levitating and says in accented Common that she wishes to talk, and promises that right now the adventurers are not in any danger from her and the Drow. The other two female Drow follow, but upon foot, and remain behind Madame Nova in a respectful distance. Madame Nova does not threaten the adventurers, but seeks to unravel how they discovered her band of renegade Drow. She is very interested in their intentions and will listen intently when the adventurers speak. Madame Nova is a Drow of noble descent and the DM must play her as such. She had an excellent education and is from a mid-level prestigious family. She is middle age according to how Drow count their years. She will not be hostile to the adventurers even if there is a member that is of a traditional enemy race. Once that Madame Nova has determined that the adventurers are friendly, she will order them released and fed, but will not have their things returned to them until they leave (she is not a fool). If the adventurers are hostile to her, or threaten her, she will have them put back asleep with poison and then transport them to the surface. She will ensure that the adventurers are left far enough away that they could not get back to her enclave and within the hunting range of a fearsome creature like a manticores. If the adventurers are obnoxious to the point of pissing her off, she may have them tied to a tree or have their hands tied behind their back and let loose with bags of monster attractant hung around their necks.

Friendly and behaved adventurers will live longer and are invited to a dinner. She introduces her two companions as Darien and Theana, both half sisters to Madame Nova and help her maintain order. While eating, Madame Nova explains that she is the leader of this band of renegade Drow and that most of them worship Vhaeraun, the Drow god of thievery and furthering the interests of Drow upon the surface world. Although the worship of Vhaeraun is done primarily by males, Madame Nova and those females with her has been accepted by the deity. Following the tenets of her faith, Madame Nova desires peaceful trade with the surface world. She desires to arrange a trade mission with the adventurers but after they prove they can reach the surface again. When the adventurers return to the Underdark later, she will meet them to arrange trade and payment. The adventurers are allowed to remain for a few days to rest and heal, and if lacking any of the basic adventuring gear, the Drow may give it to them at the DM's discretion.

Precious information is gained from befriending the Drow. Madame Nova explains the dungeon past the enclave, and departs the information that there are two teleportation arches that provide access to other parts of the Forgotten Halls. Probably dwarven made, these arches are protected by riddles answered in the language that the riddle is written in. She does not impart the answers to the riddles because she desires to test the worthiness of the adventurers, and see if they can survive. Madame Nova explains that while there are several natural caverns and chasms in the complex, it is better to stick with the crafted halls, as the other sections are quite dangerous, and little explored. She also informs the adventurers about the access to the surface through the last teleportation mirror similar to the one that they employed to enter the halls, accessed through a descending natural passageway. The passage ends in a large natural cavern used as a pasture by wild rothe, but the Drow do not where on the surface it deposits the travelers. The Drow use another way of reaching the surface, one that they are not going to divulge to strangers. A rough map provided by Madame Nova details the complex to the first teleportation arch. She also gives the adventurers the password in the Drow language to safely pass the lightning golem, and deactivate the petrification trap at the bottom of the stairs from room #8. The Drow will not provide an escort or guide, as that would threaten their anonymity among the other Drow of the region. Depending upon whether or not the DM desires to use alternate rules for exposure, the Drow may furnish the characters with several decanters of fresh water, unless the characters have sufficient means of attaining water by magic.

While remaining within the enclave, the adventurers are free to talk to the other Drow. The other two co-leaders of the enclave, Darien and Theana, keep their motives to themselves but are guardedly friendly. All of the Drow are careful not to divulge their full names, houses, or anything else that could give their enclave away. Darien and Theana have experienced the surface before on raids, under the patronage of a mysterious Lord Jack. They have recently returned to the Underdark and joined the enclave ran by their half sister. Theana worships Mystra, and is a